10

COLOUR CONSIDERATION FOR GARMENTS

10.1 INTRODUCTION

Colour combination has a very important place in tailoring. It is essential for every student of dress making as well as for all tailors to have knowledge of colour combinations in order to use them effectively on clothes, buttons, accessories, etc. Inadequate knowledge will result in garments with poor colour combinations which do not look good. Good combinations make a garment look attractive, hence knowledge of colour combinations is very important.

10.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson you will be able to :

- explain colour schemes;
- explain colour contrasts;
- use colour combinations for matching cloth, thread and buttons;
- list points to be kept in mind while using a colour scheme.

10.3 COLOUR SCHEME

All colours - whether they are primary, secondary or neutral, are used in tailoring. Black and white are not shades of any colour. Black is the colour of mourning whereas white

signifies purity. Colours are of various kinds, like -

1. Primary colours

These are those colours which are naturally present and can be made by combining other colours. These are -

i) Red

ii) Blue

iii) Yellow

i) Red colour

This is a very bright and attractive colour. It affects the mental state of person. As it is very bright, great care has to be taken while using it. It is a warm colour.

ii) Blue colour

It is a cool colour and is used to denote water or the sky.

iii) Yellow colour

This is also a bright colour and is generally used at weddings, etc.

2. Secondary colours

The colour obtained on mixing two primary colours is known as a secondary colour. Example :-

Red + Yellow = Orange

Yellow + Blue = Green

Blue + Red = Purple

In this way we obtain three secondary colours. Some of these are cool and some are warm. Every primary colour has three contrasts and very secondary colour has one primary contrast, such as green has red as the primary contrast.

10.4 COLOUR CONTRAST

Every primary colour is a contrast of other primary colour. A garment looks attractive if proper contrasts are used. This is also known as complementary contrast. For example:-

Yellow, blue, green	for red
Blue, red, purple	for yellow
Yellow, red, orange	for blue

Neutral colours are black, grey and white

Hence, adequate knowledge of colour contrasts helps in creating designs for garments and also helps one while buying readymade garments. Using colour schemes is an art which is difficult to apply.

10.5 USING COLOUR SCHEMES

The following points should be kept in mind while using colour schemes :-

1. According to the base of the garment

First of all for the base of the garment, that is, the cloth should be seen because the colours used will depend upon it. While using the colour scheme, it is best to use one colour first and then gradually use other colours. Not more than two or three colours should be used in a colour scheme.

2. According to the design

Design are of many kinds. Natural colours should be used when using designs from nature, such as birds, flowers, plants, etc. The natural colours look best on such designs. Geometrical designs can be made in any desired colour which looks good.

3. According to the wearer

Bright attractive colours and nursery prints look good on children's garments. Care should be taken while selecting colours and designs for garments of adults. Bright colours suit children garments. Adults garment look good in dark colours whereas older persons garments look best in light and sober colours. Hence, colour schemes should be used according to the garment and according to the age of the wearer.

4. According to climate and tradition

Both climate and tradition have a great influence on colour schemes of garments. Light colours are preferred in summer and dark colours in winter. If dark colours are used in summer they hurt the eye and are not very pleasant.

10.6 COLOUR HARMONY

Colour harmony refers to the harmonious and pleasing use of colour combinations. One should never use more than five colours if one wants to achieve colour harmony. Contrasting colours should also be carefully selected so that a pleasant effect is achieved. Harmony is of the following kinds.

1. Analogous harmony

The colours which gradually merge together are used together like yellow, green yellow and green.

2. Monochromatic harmony

When shades of any one colour are used together, ranging from light to dark, monochromatic harmony is achieved, e.g. - light blue and dark blue.

3. Complementary harmony

When complementary colours are used together it is called complementary harmony, e.g. - yellow green is used with its complements red and purple. and blue-purple is used with its complements yellow and red. Dark colours look good when used in combination such as orange colour on a brown coat.

4. Dominant harmony

Many shades of colours are used on garments and out of those used, the dominant colour forms the dominant harmony. Any desired colour can be highlighted by making an outline of its contrasting colour. For example, the yellow colour of a frock can be highlighted by using green colour on it either as piping or as the embroidery thread.

5. Related harmony

When the colour formed by the combination of two primary colours, is used with a neutral colour, related harmony is obtained. For example -

Red + Yellow = Orange

Related harmony - Orange + grey; orange + black; orange + white

CHARACTERISTICS OF COLOURS

There are some colours which create an atmosphere of warmth and others which give an effect of coolness. Colours can be thus divided as -

i) Warm Colours

These are red, yellow, orange, brown, etc.

ii) Cool colours

These are blue, green, grey, dark blue, etc.

10.7 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about colour harmony, colour contrasting and about the points to be kept in mind while using colour schemes.

10.8 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. Describe the points to be kept in mind while using a colour scheme.
2. Describe the various kinds of colour harmony.